

Lunchtime Supervisor – Primary

The Lunchtime Supervisor plays an essential role in cultivating a safe, orderly, and positive environment during the lunchtime period within our academy for younger pupils. This position is vital for ensuring the well-being of our students, facilitating their responsible conduct, and maintaining adherence to academy policies across dining areas, social spaces, and outdoor play areas. You will be a visible and supportive presence, contributing significantly to a harmonious and enjoyable break time for all children as they engage in play and develop their social skills within a structured setting.

Core Purpose

The core purpose of the Lunchtime Supervisor is to actively supervise and manage student behaviour during the lunchtime period, ensuring a secure and positive atmosphere for our younger learners. This involves promoting respectful social interactions, particularly in shared spaces, maintaining order in communal areas, and efficiently managing student movement, including helping children get to and from the dining hall. By upholding academy rules and providing necessary support and guidance, the Lunchtime Supervisor contributes directly to the safety, well-being, and positive experience of every student, enabling them to return to lessons refreshed and ready to learn.

Key Areas of Responsibility

1. Student Supervision and Behaviour Management

- Supervise and manage student behaviour in assigned areas of the academy during lunchtime, including dining areas, classrooms used for eating, and outdoor play areas, ensuring a calm and orderly environment suitable for young children.
- Ensure the efficient and orderly movement of students to and from dining areas at the appropriate times, promoting smooth transitions for smaller groups and individual children.
- Promote positive behaviour and maintain order in the dining hall, including effective management of queuing, encouraging healthy eating habits, assisting with spills, and ensuring appropriate disposal of waste, to ensure the safety and well-being of all students.
- Consistently enforce academy rules and expectations regarding student conduct during lunchtime, providing clear and age-appropriate boundaries.
- Address and resolve behavioural issues effectively and fairly in line with academy policies, escalating serious incidents or persistent challenges to senior staff as necessary.

- Provide support and guidance to students as needed, offering a helpful and approachable presence, especially for those who may need reassurance or assistance during break time.
- Deal with any incidents of misbehaviour or conflict effectively and fairly, promoting resolution and teaching children how to interact positively.

2. Safety and Well-being

- Maintain a safe and secure environment for all students during lunchtime, identifying and mitigating potential risks specific to younger children in play areas and communal spaces.
- Monitor student behaviour closely and ensure compliance with academy rules and expectations, intervening proactively where necessary, especially to prevent accidents or unkindness.
- Promote positive social interactions and respectful conduct among students, fostering a harmonious community where children learn to share and play together.
- Report any concerns regarding student safety or well-being to the appropriate staff members promptly and accurately, ensuring timely intervention for any pastoral or welfare needs.
- Administer basic first aid if required (relevant training will be provided), responding effectively and calmly to minor injuries or illnesses, and comforting distressed children.
- Promote and safeguard the welfare of students at all times, adhering strictly to the academy's safeguarding policies and procedures, understanding the vulnerabilities of younger pupils.
- Contribute to a positive and supportive environment where students feel safe, comfortable, and able to seek help from a responsible adult, recognising that younger children may be more reliant on adult support.

3. General Duties and Professional Practice

- Assist with other duties as directed by senior staff, demonstrating flexibility and a willingness to support the wider academy team during the busy lunchtime period. This may include helping with setting up or clearing down dining areas suitable for young children.
- Act as a positive role model through personal and professional conduct, upholding the academy's values and demonstrating kindness and patience.
- Work collaboratively as a member of the lunchtime supervision team, contributing positively to effective working relations and communication with colleagues.
- Be proficient in basic literacy and numeracy skills to support daily tasks and record-keeping, such as incident reports or attendance notes.
- Safeguard the health and safety of all students both on the Academy premises and when engaged in authorised school activities elsewhere, with particular attention to playground safety and supervision for younger age groups.
- Contribute to the effective running of the Academy during the lunchtime period, ensuring a smooth and enjoyable break for all children.

Person Specification – Lunchtime Supervisor

This section outlines the essential and desirable attributes for the Lunchtime Supervisor role in a primary setting:

Qualifications and Training

Desirable:

- Certified First Aid Trained (training will be provided if not already held).
- Training in basic behaviour management strategies.

Experience

Essential:

- Experience of working with children or young people in a supervisory capacity, such as in a school, nursery, or community group setting.
- Experience of maintaining order and promoting positive behaviour in a group setting, specifically with younger children.

Desirable:

- Experience supervising children in a primary school environment.
- Experience in dealing with minor incidents or conflicts among young children, showing patience and fairness.
- Experience in a role requiring responsibility and reliability, particularly in a fixed routine.
- Experience assisting with simple care needs (e.g., helping with coats, finding belongings).

Knowledge and Understanding

Essential:

- Fundamental understanding of safeguarding principles and their application in an educational setting, with particular awareness of the signs of concern in younger children.
- Clear understanding of duty of care responsibilities towards children and young people, recognising the varying levels of independence across age groups.
- Basic knowledge of age-appropriate play, social interactions, and common developmental stages of children.

Desirable:

- Knowledge of effective behaviour management strategies for primary school-aged children, including positive reinforcement and diversion techniques.
- Awareness of common social dynamics and potential conflicts among young children, and strategies for guiding them towards positive resolution.
- Understanding of basic playground safety and supervision best practices.
- Familiarity with routines and expectations for primary school pupils.

Skills and Abilities

Essential:

- Good communication skills, enabling clear, calm, and effective interaction with students, parents, and staff.
- Ability to supervise groups of children effectively, maintaining vigilance and control, especially during active playtimes.
- Ability to work constructively and collaboratively as part of a team, communicating effectively with colleagues.
- Strong observational skills to identify student needs, potential issues, or children who may be withdrawn or upset.
- Capacity to follow instructions and implement academy policies consistently and fairly.
- Patience and empathy when dealing with young children, understanding their emotional responses and varying needs.

Desirable:

- Ability to administer basic first aid calmly and competently, particularly for common childhood injuries.
- Ability to de-escalate minor conflicts or disagreements between children using age-appropriate methods.
- Proactive approach to identifying and addressing potential issues before they escalate, especially during free play.
- Ability to initiate and participate in simple games or activities with children.
- Good organisational skills for managing equipment or resources during lunchtime.

Personal Qualities

The Lunchtime Supervisor will be a **highly responsible** and **reliable individual**, possessing a **calm and approachable demeanour** that fosters **trust and respect** among students. They will demonstrate **excellent communication skills**, enabling **clear and consistent interaction**, and will be adept at promoting positive social behaviours and harmonious play among young children. This role calls for an individual who is both **vigilant and empathetic**, **capable of maintaining order** while also offering **support, comfort**, and **guidance** to younger pupils. They will be a **dedicated team player**, committed to creating a **safe, positive, and enjoyable lunchtime experience** for every student, consistently upholding the academy's values and expectations. A genuine enjoyment of working with young children and their boundless energy is key.

Safeguarding of Students and Duty of Care

All staff, regardless of role, level of seniority and location, have a responsibility to ensure the highest levels of safeguarding and promoting the welfare of our pupils, and we expect all our staff and volunteers to share this commitment. We must collectively create an environment where children feel safe to learn, play, and grow. Children should feel comfortable in their surroundings and know that they can approach any responsible adult with any problems or concerns.

All staff must be able to identify any children who are at risk of harm, and know the characteristics of abuse or neglect. If you suspect or confirm harm then it's essential you know what actions to take.

Annual safeguarding training is offered to all staff at Leigh Academies Trust, and it is the staff member's responsibility to be aware of the most up to date guidance documented in the [Keeping Children Safe in Education document](#) (Department of Education).

Notes

The job description allocates duties and responsibilities but does not direct the particular amount of time to be spent on carrying them out and no part of it may be so construed. This job description is not necessarily a comprehensive definition of the post. It will be reviewed at least once a year and may be subject to modification or amendment at any time after consultation with the holder of the post.

The duties may be varied to meet the changing demands of the academy/business unit at the reasonable discretion of the Principal/Director. This job description does not form part of the contract of employment. It describes the way the post-holder is expected and required to perform and complete the particular duties as set out in the foregoing.